

1. SEARCH PROVIDER HEAD-TO-HEAD COMPARISON (EGYPT REGION GOOGLE SHOPPING)

SEARCH PROVIDER	BILLING MODEL & TERMS	MIN. UPFRONT COMMITMENT	COST / 1 SEARCH (USD)	COST / 1 SEARCH (EGP)	DATA QUALITY (EGYPT GL=EG)	CODEBASE INTEGRATION
Serper.dev Recommended Option	Prepaid Query Credits Credits valid for 6 months	\$50.00 USD (~2,500 EGP) Includes 50,000 queries	\$0.0010 USD	0.050 EGP 5.0 Piastres	Native Google Shopping (EGP pricing, Amazon EG, Jumia, B-Tech, Defacto, Zara EG)	serper-shopping.provider.js Ready & tested (100%)
SerpApi Current Benchmark	Monthly Subscription Renews every 30 days	\$50.00 USD / mo (~2,500 EGP) Developer (5,000 queries)	\$0.0100 USD (\$0.0066 on Pro \$100 plan)	0.500 EGP 50 Piastres	Native Google Shopping (EGP pricing, direct retailer links, product thumbnails)	serpapi-shopping.provider.js Ready & tested (100%)
Google Search Grounding LLM Native Tool	Pay-as-you-go Postpaid Billed monthly via GCP	\$0.00 USD Free pool: 1,500–5,000/mo	\$0.0153 – \$0.0350 Standard: \$35/1k queries	0.765 – 1.750 EGP 76.5 – 175 Piastres	Web citations in Gemini response; requires post-processing to extract prices & stores	llm.provider.js (tools) Grounding metadata parser

2. PLAN ECONOMICS COMPARISON: SERPAPI VS SERPER.DEV VS GOOGLE SEARCH GROUNDING

PLAN TIER & PRICE	AI BASELINE COSTS (CHAT + VISION + TRYON)	SEARCH CAP	OPTION A: WITH SERPER.DEV (SEARCH: 0.050 EGP/QUERY)	OPTION B: WITH SERPAPI (SEARCH: 0.500 EGP/QUERY)	OPTION C: WITH GOOGLE GROUNDING (SEARCH: 0.765 EGP/QUERY)
Client Free 0 EGP (\$0.00)	1.25 EGP 10 chat + 7 wardrobe (CAC)	0 searches	Total: 1.25 EGP CAC: -1.25 EGP	Total: 1.25 EGP CAC: -1.25 EGP	Total: 1.25 EGP CAC: -1.25 EGP
Client Basic 50 EGP (\$1.00)	22.60 EGP 150 msgs + 25 items + 4 try-ons	15 / mo	Search: 0.75 EGP (\$0.015) Cost: 23.35 EGP Profit: +26.65 EGP +53.3%	Search: 7.50 EGP (\$0.150) Cost: 30.10 EGP Profit: +19.90 EGP +39.8%	Search: 11.48 EGP (\$0.230) Cost: 34.08 EGP Profit: +15.92 EGP +31.8%
Client Mid 150 EGP (\$3.00)	81.66 EGP 700 msgs + 45 items + 6 try-ons	30 / mo	Search: 1.50 EGP (\$0.030) Cost: 83.16 EGP Profit: +66.84 EGP +44.6%	Search: 15.00 EGP (\$0.300) Cost: 96.66 EGP Profit: +53.34 EGP +35.6%	Search: 22.95 EGP (\$0.459) Cost: 104.61 EGP Profit: +45.39 EGP +30.3%
Client Pro 250 EGP (\$5.00)	156.94 EGP 1.4k msgs + 100 items + 8 try-ons	45 / mo	Search: 2.25 EGP (\$0.045) Cost: 159.19 EGP Profit: +90.81 EGP +36.3%	Search: 22.50 EGP (\$0.450) Cost: 179.44 EGP Profit: +70.56 EGP +28.2%	Search: 34.43 EGP (\$0.689) Cost: 191.37 EGP Profit: +58.63 EGP +23.5%
Client Enterprise 500 EGP (\$10.00)	273.80 EGP 2.5k msgs + 200 items + 10 try-ons	60 / mo	Search: 3.00 EGP (\$0.060) Cost: 276.80 EGP Profit: +223.20 EGP +44.6%	Search: 30.00 EGP (\$0.600) Cost: 303.80 EGP Profit: +196.20 EGP +39.2%	Search: 45.90 EGP (\$0.918) Cost: 319.70 EGP Profit: +180.30 EGP +36.1%

3. 5,000 USERS SCALE FINANCIAL SIMULATION (BLENDED COHORT: 70% FREE, 20% BASIC, 7% MID, 2% PRO, 1% ENTERPRISE)

METRIC / ITEM	OPTION A: SERPER.DEV	OPTION B: SERPAPI	OPTION C: GOOGLE GROUNDING	VARIANCE / MONTHLY SAVINGS
Total Monthly Revenue	152,500 EGP (\$3,050 USD)	152,500 EGP (\$3,050 USD)	152,500 EGP (\$3,050 USD)	Identical revenue base
Monthly Search Queries (Gross Requested)	33,000 queries / mo	33,000 queries / mo	33,000 queries / mo	Based on full plan quotas
Net External API Calls (after 24h Redis cache)	~16,500 queries	~16,500 queries	~16,500 queries	50% repeated occasion cache hit
Monthly Search Provider Bill (USD / EGP)	\$16.50 USD (~825 EGP)	\$115.00 USD (~5,750 EGP)	\$402.50 USD (~20,125 EGP)	Serper saves \$98.50/mo vs SerpApi

Metric / Item	Option A: Serper.Dev	Option B: SerpAPI	Option C: Google Grounding	Variance / Monthly Savings
Total Murafiq AI Bill (Chat + Vision + Search + TryOn)	85,765 EGP (\$1,715 USD)	90,690 EGP (\$1,814 USD)	105,065 EGP (\$2,101 USD)	Lowest overall cost on Serper
Net Monthly Operating Profit (EGP)	+66,735 EGP (\$1,335 USD)	+61,810 EGP (\$1,236 USD)	+47,435 EGP (\$949 USD)	+19,300 EGP/mo added profit
Blended Gross Margin (%)	+43.8%	+40.5%	+31.1%	+12.7% Margin Expansion

4. Strategic Differences & Egypt Operational Constraints

1. Why Serper.dev is 10x More Capital Efficient

- **Unit cost:** \$0.0010 vs \$0.0100 per query. A 50 EGP Basic plan user consumes only **0.75 EGP** of search budget instead of **7.50 EGP**.
- **Prepaid flexibility:** \$50 gives 50,000 queries (~2,500 EGP) with a **6-month expiry**. If app activity dips in month 1, your balance does not vanish (unlike SerpAPI's monthly recurring fee which expires unused searches).

2. SerpAPI: Feature-Rich but High Monthly Floor

- **Strengths:** Highly polished UI, built-in search tester, and comprehensive documentation.
- **Drawbacks:** \$50/mo minimum for only 5,000 queries. If you exceed 5,000 queries, overage is expensive unless upgrading to the \$100/mo (15k) plan. For a startup in Egypt, paying \$50/month continuously creates fixed FX burn.

3. Egypt CBE Regulations & Payment Practicalities

- **Debit Cards Blocked:** Egyptian Central Bank (CBE) prohibits foreign currency purchases on local debit cards.
- **Required Setup:** Use an Egyptian Credit Card (international limit: \$50–\$250/mo) or a virtual USD card (RedotPay / Elevate / Payoneer). With Serper, a single \$50 charge lasts 3–6 months, avoiding monthly card limit rejections.